

A PARABLE OF RESTRAINT

A sword entered the tearoom. It did not leave unchanged.

Steam Over Cold Steel is a spare historical parable about Sen no Rikyu, Kato Masanobu, and the moment when duty, violence, ceremony, and conscience meet inside the narrow door of a tea hut.

Sent with an order of death, a samurai expects weakness. Instead he encounters silence, ritual, and a gentleness strong enough to unsettle command itself.

This is a story about restraint under pressure, honor without cruelty, and the strange power of a bowl of tea to outlast the edge of a blade.

Kevin L. Michel writes practical philosophy, literary parables, and works of inner discipline for readers interested in power, conscience, and the difficult art of self-command.



WHEN FORCE GROWS COLD, STEAM REMEMBERS
THE LIVING HAND.

A HISTORICAL PARABLE

Steam Over Cold Steel



A HISTORICAL PARABLE OF TEA, STEEL, DUTY, AND
RESTRAINT



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